RE: A query concerning whether I can complete your BSc biological sciences degree without an A*

From: bioadmissions bioadmissions@herts.ac.uk
To: Aryan Thanki aryanthanki313@hotmail.com
Date: Wed, 6 Nov 2024, 21:41

Hello Aryan,

Thank you for your interest in our BSc Biological Science degree.

Parallel to what the senior Admissions tutor at Imperial College stated, our courses are also structured to be accessible to students with diverse educational backgrounds, thanks to our first-year modules, which provide all students with the foundational knowledge in biosciences disciplines necessary to approach the complexity of the topics taught at Level 5 and 6 and thrive in their academic journey.

Although our entry requirements are not as stringent as those of Imperial College, a strong knowledge of biology and chemistry is highly desirable and will definitely support your studies.

I hope this helps. Please do not hesitate to contact us again if you need any further clarifications.

Best wishes,
Danilo

From: Aryan Thanki <aryanthanki313@hotmail.com>
Sent: 06 November 2024 11:48
To: bioadmissions <bioadmissions@herts.ac.uk>
Subject: Re: A query concerning whether I can complete your BSc biological sciences degree without an A*

Hello

I hope to hear from you soon concerning my query. I would like to know whether I can complete the biological science degree without having or obtaining an A* level understanding of A Level Sciences, particularly Biology and Chemistry A Level

Thanks

Aryan

Sent from Outlook for iOS

From: Aryan Thanki <aryanthanki313@hotmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, November 5, 2024 12:48:19 PM
To: bioadmissions <bioadmissions@herts.ac.uk>
Subject: Re: A query concerning whether I can complete your BSc biological sciences degree without an A*

Hello

I hope to hear from you soon regarding this. Can I complete the BSC biological science course without having an A* level understanding in a level biology and/or chemistry

Many thanks

Aryan

Sent from Outlook for iOS

From: Aryan Thanki
Sent: Tuesday, November 5, 2024 4:07:12 AM
To: bioadmissions <bioadmissions@herts.ac.uk>
Subject: A query concerning whether I can complete your BSc biological sciences degree without an A*

Hello

I have contacted Imperial College London concerning a query I have and they have given me this response:

Thank you for getting in touch with us and for your astute question about complexity and accessibility of the course *vs* entry requirements. One contributing factor to the grades that university departments across the UK ask for is related to competition, i.e. the number of applicants to places. Another factor is reflecting the academic level and complexity of the degree programme itself.

Whilst our Chemistry degree programmes are very competitive (7.8:1, applications:places in the last cycle), the depth and breadth of academic content, the complexity (both conceptual and analytical) and level of application and problem-solving within the course from Year 1 onwards, are

absolutely reflected in our high entry requirements. Our requirement for A-Level Maths (which many departments do not require for all or some of their Chemistry degrees) reflects the level of maths embedded within the course, and the application of maths required. We do structure the course to be accessible to all of our students, regardless of their educational background. However, assessments (inc. exam questions) are indeed designed to be answered/completed by high ability and high achieving students (e.g. A-A*) as you mentioned.

We shortlist applicants for interview, based on their entire UCAS application. We then use the interview to gain feedback on how students apply their knowledge, show their understanding, and problem-solve (as well as to assess motivations, engagement and their communication of Chemistry). This helps to inform our offer-making decision process.

As you can see above, they have clearly stated that the academic level, the academic content, difficulty and complexity of the course in question are all reflected in the entry requirements they ask for. This reply came from the senior admissions tutor who is also the head of chemistry at imperial.

Similarly, for the UH biological science degree program, can I complete the course without having an A* level understanding at A Level in Biology A Level since you do not ask for an A* in Biology A Level for admissions?

Regards

Aryan

Sent from Outlook for iOS